

Bracket 1

Cisco Youth Leadership Award

About the Applicant

What is the best email to contact you at?

abdurewzebtu143@gmail.com

Date of Birth

11/07/1998

How old are you?

27

Pronouns

He/Him

Phone number (please include area code if applicable)

+251935444997

City of Residence

Addis Ababa

Country of Residence

Ethiopia

Country of Citizenship

Ethiopia

Please upload a scanned version of your passport. (if you don't have a passport upload government issued ID or birth certificate)

File Name: Passport.pdf

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[Passport.pdf](#)

If you have a US Visa please provide here

Download URL

Please upload a photograph/headshot of the applicant



File Name: Abdurezak Head Shoot.jpg

Download URL

[Abdurezak Head Shoot.jpg](#)

Applicant Role/Title at organization

Co-Founder / Managing Director

Applicant Bio (500 Characters/ 150 words max)

I am Abdurezak Co-Founder/Managing Director of Dabbal Technologies, a youth-focused digital skills and employment ecosystem in Ethiopia. I lead the design of technology-driven learning platforms, workforce systems, and public-sector digital solutions that connect underserved youth to skills, jobs, and income. Dabbal has trained and placed youth into employment and partnered with universities and government institutions to deploy large-scale digital systems impacting over 100,000 young people.

Applicant LinkedIn URL:

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/abdurezak100/>

About Your Organization

Organization Name

DABBAL SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

Organization Website

<https://debbal.com/>

Organizational Bio (750 Characters/ 250 words max)

Dabbal Technologies is a technology-driven youth empowerment organization operating an integrated ecosystem of digital learning platforms, physical training hubs, staffing and job placement services, and public-sector digital systems. The organization focuses on unemployed youth, women, university graduates, and low-income communities. Dabbal delivers practical digital skills, links graduates to internships, employment, freelancing, and entrepreneurship opportunities, and builds scalable technology solutions for institutions. In partnership with universities and the

Ethiopian Ministry of Peace, Dabbal has deployed national-level digital systems supporting youth training, coordination, and workforce participation.

What are the 3 most relevant Global Goals are you working to achieve?

1. No Poverty
4. Quality Education
5. Gender Equality
8. Decent Work and Economic Growth

Provide links to supporting press/media coverage/speeches

YVMS(ETV): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EEh2XLIFOUU> FDRE MoP Post-
<https://web.facebook.com/share/p/1AegTNK6Q2/>

Organization's Social Media: Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, LinkedIn

Facebook: <https://web.facebook.com/profile.php?id=100083346097498> Instagram:
<https://www.instagram.com/dabbalsoftwaresplc/> Twitter: <https://x.com/DabbalSoftwares/> LinkedIn
(Dabbal Software): <https://www.linkedin.com/company/dabbal/?viewAsMember=true> LinkedIn
(Dabbal Tech Academy): <https://www.linkedin.com/showcase/debbal-iih/?viewAsMember=true>
Google Drive:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1stie7R5KkiSmRa9brvrXDtJKopJuYtI5?usp=drive_link
Tiktok: <https://www.tiktok.com/@debbaltechzone>

What stage of development is your organization in? Please select what phase most applies to you and explain why in the text box below.

Established: You have made at least 3 years of demonstrable impact in your Global Goal(s).

Explain why you are in this stage of development? 150 words/500 Characters?

Dabbal Technologies is in the Established stage, having delivered multiple years of demonstrable impact across digital skills training, job placement, freelancing support, and public-sector technology systems. We operate live platforms, maintain institutional partnerships with universities and government ministries, and have supported youth employment and deployment at national scale, including systems impacting over 100,000 young people.

Pitch

Please follow these guidelines when submitting videos:

- Keep file names under 30 characters
- Do not include special characters in file names.

- Once uploaded, your video will take some time to be rendered, depending on size. This can be anywhere from 30 seconds to a few minutes or longer.
- You will see a placeholder video in this spot while the video is processed.
- To check to see if your video is ready to be viewed, please refresh your page (you can do this by clicking the "Dashboard" icon).
- If you are uploading a very large file or using a slow internet connection, be aware that the system will time out after 60 minutes.
- Your video will need to be published before you can submit your application.

We strongly advise you do not try to upload your video right before the submission deadline.

Your Pitch - In a 1-2 min video, explain why your organization deserves this award. An example of a good pitch . identifies a clear problem that the organization aims to solve, the technology innovation solution presented to address this problem, the impact that you have had thus far, and how this prize will help further your mission. Please note we will be assessing the individual as well as the organization. The applicant must be the individual presenting this pitch.

File Name: DABBAL CISCO PITCH.mp4

Download URL

[DABBAL CISCO PITCH.mp4](#)

If you are unable to upload a video you can share a YouTube URL here

https://youtu.be/z-e8le_PdLo

I have uploaded a pitch video or YouTube link. Please note that this is mandatory requirement failure to upload will disqualify your application.

I have uploaded a video or YouTube URL

In 250 words/ 750 Characters or less, explain why your organization deserves this award. This can look very similar to the script of your pitch. Give us the story of your organization- Please outline your organization's vision, mission, issue focus, community context, and background.

Dabbal Technologies was founded to address youth unemployment and poverty by transforming access to technology into real economic opportunity. We operate a blended ecosystem combining digital learning platforms, physical academies, staffing and job placement pathways, and institutional digital systems. Our work prioritizes unemployed youth, women, and low-income communities. Through partnerships with universities and the Ethiopian Ministry of Peace, we have deployed scalable digital solutions that trained and coordinated over 100,000 young people. The Cisco Youth Leadership Award would enable us to expand our technology infrastructure, strengthen job-matching systems, and reach more underserved youth with sustainable income pathways.

Criteria

Technology Innovation

Technology Innovation: We are looking for an organization that innovates with technology or Internet-based communications to improve efficiency, reach, and magnify impact.

Tell us how your organization's technological innovation is core to ending extreme poverty. How does your organization leverage technology to a) achieve results, b) deliver your solution/services, and/or c) innovate new solutions? Please give specific examples of your technology innovation.

Technology is central to Dabbal's mission to reduce poverty. We design and operate digital learning management systems, workforce tracking tools, and deployment platforms that improve access, efficiency, and scale. Our ecosystem integrates online learning, physical training hubs, digital portfolios, and employer linkages to translate skills into income. In partnership with the Ethiopian Ministry of Peace, we developed and operated a national youth volunteer management and e-learning system that supported the training and deployment of over 100,000 young people. Our leadership team includes Cisco-certified professionals, ensuring secure, scalable, and standards-based technology solutions.

Impact

Impact: We are looking for a demonstrated track record of measurable impact at scale over the last 3-5 years advancing one or more of the Global Goals.

Tell us how your intervention addresses the problem and what measurable impact you've made in achieving one or more of the Global Goals, using qualitative and quantitative evidence. Please provide impact statistics where relevant.

Dabbal addresses youth unemployment by combining skills development with direct employment pathways. We have trained and mentored over 500 academy students, many of whom secured jobs, internships, freelance income, or launched startups through our recommendation and employer linkages. We Also helped more than 10 startup companies and 5 tech communities to establish. At national scale, our government-partnered digital platform supported the training and deployment of over 100,000 youth into volunteer and job-related activities across Ethiopia. Qualitatively, beneficiaries report increased employability, income opportunities, and leadership capacity. Our work advances SDGs 1, 4, and 8 by converting digital skills into economic participation.

Vision

As a strong leader within your organization, please explain your vision and concrete plans for scaling your impact in the next 3-5 years, including how the Cisco Youth Leadership Award platform and prize money will advance efforts to achieve your mission.

When describing how you plan to scale, please provide metrics of how your organization will distribute the money where possible.

Our vision is to build a scalable, technology-powered youth employment infrastructure across Ethiopia and the region. Over the next 3–5 years, we plan to expand our LMS nationally, strengthen AI-enabled job matching, grow staffing and employer partnerships, and increase access for women and low-income youth. The Cisco Youth Leadership Award funding would be allocated to platform scaling, infrastructure, curriculum expansion, and workforce placement systems, with a target of reaching over 250,000 youth and enabling at least 50,000 direct income opportunities through employment, freelancing, or entrepreneurship.

Catalyst

Catalyst: We are looking for an organization and individual that inspires other young people to take action to end extreme poverty. Tell us how you as a leader and your organization build momentum among your community to achieve one or more of the Global Goals. Please provide specific examples of: strong cross-sectoral partnerships, broad volunteer base, unpaid media coverage, viral campaigns (including crowdsourcing), local/community awards, successfully advocating for change, speaking engagements, mentoring, or more.

We actively build momentum by mobilizing youth, institutions, and partners around technology-driven solutions to unemployment. Dabbal works across sectors, partnering with universities, government ministries, employers, and tech communities. We engage a broad youth volunteer base, mentor emerging leaders, and support alumni to launch startups and community initiatives. Our programs inspire young people to view technology as a tool for social and economic change, not just personal advancement. Through speaking engagements, training delivery, and mentorship, I encourage youth to take action, collaborate, and create sustainable solutions to poverty.

Citizenship

Global Citizenship: We are looking for someone who demonstrates the values and embodies the spirit of a Global Citizen. Tell us how your core values drive you as an individual and your organization to stand out as a leader in your industry. An example of this may be how you live your mission in day to day life.

“Dabbal” means “roommate.” The name reflects how this journey began five of us sharing a university dorm room, learning together, supporting each other, and believing that collaboration could create opportunity beyond ourselves. That same spirit guides my approach to global

citizenship today. I use my skills, time, and leadership to expand access to technology for underserved youth, women, and low-income communities. I work across public institutions, private partners, and communities to build shared solutions rather than isolated success. By turning collaboration into systems that create jobs, skills, and dignity, I strive to show that ethical, inclusive technology leadership can address global challenges like poverty and unemployment.

Supplemental Organization Details

Please upload your organization's registration details, including one or more of: the certificate of registration, certificate of incorporation, certificate of tax exemption

File Name: trade registration.pdf

Download URL

[trade registration.pdf](#)

Annual report

File Name: 2024 financial statement.pdf

Download URL

[2024 financial statement.pdf](#)

Business plan/Strategy doc

File Name: Dabbal Technologies.pdf

Download URL

[Dabbal Technologies.pdf](#)

Profit/Loss Statement

File Name: Profit and Loss.pdf

Download URL

[Profit and Loss.pdf](#)

How did you hear about the Cisco Youth Leadership Award?

LinkedIn

Global Citizen Website

Other

If you chose "Other" please elaborate

<https://www.ictworks.org/>

I accept the

[2026 Cisco Youth Leadership Award Terms and Conditions](https://files.skild.com/Cisco%20Global%20Citizen/CYLA%202026/2026%20Global%20Citizen%20Prize_%20Cisco%20Youth%20Leadership%20Award%20-%20T%26C.pdf)

I agree